

UGONNA EZENEKWE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

First Class Sociology with Criminology graduate looking to start a career in internal audit, with practical experience assessing governance, risk management and internal control environments. I have independently audited two simulated organisations against NIST CSF, PCI DSS and UK GDPR, identifying control gaps, building risk registers and delivering audit reports and remediation roadmaps to technical and non-technical stakeholders. At Co-op I handle several thousand pounds in daily transactions accurately and in line with store procedure, which demands integrity, attention to detail and quick thinking. My degree trained me to think critically about behaviour, process and risk rather than technology alone. I am intellectually curious, work well independently and as part of a team, and am always willing to ask questions.

KEY SKILLS

Professional Skills: Integrity and Ethical Decision Making, Critical Thinking and Problem Solving, Strong Written and Oral Communication, Attention to Detail, Working Independently and in a Team, Working Under Pressure, Time Management, Adaptability

Internal Audit, Risk and Control: Internal Control Assessment, Control Gap Analysis, Risk Assessment and Risk Registers, Audit Reporting, Evidence Documentation, Remediation Roadmaps, Governance Documentation, Third Party Risk

Frameworks and Regulation: NIST CSF 2.0, PCI DSS, UK GDPR, ISO/IEC 27001:2022, Cyber Essentials, NIST Incident Response Lifecycle

Data Analysis: Excel (Lookups, Pivot Tables), SQL, Python, Splunk, Log Analysis, Wireshark, Tcpdump, Data Collection, Microsoft Office, Linux (Ubuntu)

Stakeholder Management: Reporting to Senior Managers, Drafting Briefings and Correspondence, Cross-Functional Coordination, Milestone Tracking, Action Management

Certifications: Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate (in progress)

PROJECTS

Security Control and Compliance Audits | Independent | May 2026 – Present

- Executed end to end internal audits of two simulated organisations in retail and healthcare, providing an independent assessment of each governance, risk management and internal control environment against PCI DSS, UK GDPR and NIST CSF.
- Scoped each audit through an asset inventory, then identified critical control gaps including absent least privilege access, unencrypted customer data and no disaster recovery plan.
- Built a risk register rating likelihood and impact across administrative, technical and physical controls, prioritising findings by risk to the organisation.
- Delivered written audit reports and remediation roadmaps presenting prioritised findings and recommendations to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Home SOC Lab (Splunk / Ubuntu) | Independent | May 2026 – Present

- Built and maintained an Ubuntu based security lab running Splunk and tcpdump, independently problem solving boot and configuration failures.
- Analysed log and packet capture data with Splunk, Wireshark and tcpdump to identify SYN and ICMP flood activity, tracing half open TCP connections to a single source IP and a misconfigured firewall as root cause.
- Investigated simulated brute force, ransomware, phishing and data exfiltration incidents using the NIST incident response lifecycle, recommending controls including multi factor authentication, login attempt limits, rate limiting and IDS/IPS.

SOC Analyst Simulation Training (SOC Simulator / LetsDefend) | Independent | June 2026 – Present

- Triage alerts across simulated SIEM, XDR and firewall consoles, prioritising by severity and context and correlating events into clear attack narratives.
- Documented each investigation in structured case reports, recording findings, evidence and decisions consistently and in detail.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Customer Team Member | Co-op | Dec 2025 – Present

- Handle several thousand pounds in daily transactions, working accurately and at pace through peak trading periods in line with store procedure.
- First point of contact for customers, resolving queries, complaints, till and payment issues and escalating to a duty manager where a case needs sign off.

Justice Research and Communications Intern | Reimagining Criminal Justice C.I.C. | Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Maintained a structured stakeholder database of over 50 national and international organisations, keeping data accurate, complete and retrievable for senior staff.
- Produced concise written summaries of complex documents for senior decision makers, turning dense material into actionable outputs.
- Drafted correspondence to external partner organisations in line with the organisation's sign off requirements, and coordinated research inputs across multiple workstreams to deadline.

EDUCATION

BSc Sociology with Criminology | Middlesex University | First Class Honours